



Frets on Fire



Genre: Musical

Game play

Frets on Fire is an open source clone of the ever-popular PlayStation 2 music/rhythm game Guitar Hero. It's a free download and is available for Windows, Linux and the Mac, though the Mac version is experimental.

Just like Guitar Hero, Frets on Fire features a handful of songs



and allows you to play the guitar sections with just a few keys. Instead of using a separate controller to mimic the guitar, Frets on Fire lets you pick up the keyboard and jam right in front of your desk. Best of all, a built-in editor lets you tab any song, spawning a growing community of music-moddors on the Web.

Rhythm games add an entirely new dimension of fun to gaming in the form of aural rewards. Frets on Fire takes that to a new level by allowing you to re-create familiar tunes with nothing more than your keyboard. The reward isn't getting a high score, it's listening to the song playing on your speakers and knowing you were responsible for that. The feeling you get when you effortlessly land an impossible

combination is amazing.

Also worth mentioning is the extremely entertaining tutorial. Your host, Jurgen Guntherswarchzhaffenstrassen, walks you through the game and proves that he is, indeed, much cooler than you are.

Video

The game doesn't really need anything flashier than the cartoon-isque animation it already has.

Audio

This is the best part. It's you who gets to decide how the game sounds, mistah! Mine sucked big time, though.

Download URL: <http://fretsonfire.sourceforge.net/>

Nexuiz



Genre: MMORPG (massively multi-player online role playing game)

Game play

If you have played Doom, Quake, Unreal Tournament, or any of their various free mods/clones, then you already have a good idea of what to expect from Nexuiz. Like all those games before it, Nexuiz is simple, dumb fun. Turn the game on and within 20 seconds you will be fragging people hundreds of miles away.

The community surrounding the game is not enormous, but the 500,000 plus downloads ensure that the servers will always be well stocked when you are ready to play. A small collection of North American clans has started to emerge, and the map-makers always manage to keep a steady

collection of maps flowing into the community.

However, the choice of guns is a lot less and the maps took ages to download when we tried playing it online. What's great was that there were a lot of servers to play in.

Video

When it comes to visuals, Nexuiz seems to have something for everyone. The lowest settings will easily run on very modest computers, while the highest settings make for a very nice light show. These niceties do not compare to the visuals of their modern commercial counterparts, although most are willing to forgive this since the game is entirely free and is based on a modified version of the Quake 1 engine (which came out in the mid-90s).



Audio

The sound effects really help immerse the player in the action, and can be a great help during intense 1v1 battles. However, the music is weak, derivative techno that you will surely switch off in favour of your own tunes, or just the sound effects.

Download URL: <http://www.alientrap.org/nexuiz/>